

Farm Data Use and Research Agreement

This Farm Data Use and Research Agreement (“**Agreement**”) goes into effect as of **[Date]** and until **[Date]** by and between the following parties:

Disclosing Party — Data Provider

Information	Details
Farm/Business Name	_____
Address	_____
City, State, ZIP	_____
Email	_____
Phone	_____
Primary Contact	_____

Receiving Party — Researcher/Research Institution

Information	Details
Institution/Organization	_____
Department/Laboratory	_____
Address	_____
City, State, ZIP	_____
Email	_____
Phone	_____
Primary Contact	_____

1. Purpose and Scope

This Agreement establishes the terms under which the Disclosing Party will provide farm-related data to the Receiving Party for scientific research.

The purpose of collecting this information is to support research on **[briefly describe research purpose]**. The Researcher will use the data only for the purposes described in this Agreement unless additional permission is obtained from the Disclosing Party.

Participation is voluntary. The Data Provider may decline to provide any requested information and may withdraw from the study subject to the terms described below.

2. Types of Data Provided

The Data Provider will provide the selected data types of the following information:

- Farm management and production records
- Animal health and production information
- Crop, livestock, or environmental data
- Weather or field conditions
- Soil, water, or other environmental measurements
- Input and treatment records
- Equipment or technology-generated data
- Geographic or spatial information
- Other information specifically agreed upon by the Data Provider and Researcher

The Researcher will collect only data reasonably necessary to accomplish the stated research objectives.

3. Ownership and Rights

The Data Provider retains ownership of the farm data they contribute unless otherwise expressly agreed to in writing.

Providing data to the Researcher does **not** constitute a transfer of ownership of the underlying farm records or information.

The Data Provider grants the Researcher a **[non-exclusive, royalty-free] license** to access, store, analyze, and use the contributed data for the research purposes described in this agreement.

This agreement does not grant the Researcher permission to sell the Data Provider's identifiable farm data or use it for unrelated commercial purposes without additional written authorization.

4. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The Researcher will take reasonable measures to protect confidential farm information.

Where appropriate, data will be:

- De-identified or pseudonymized;
- Aggregated with data from other farms;
- Stored using appropriate security measures; and
- Reported in a manner that reduces the risk of identifying an individual farm or farmer.

The Researcher will not intentionally publish the Data Provider's name, farm name, exact address, or other identifying information unless the Data Provider has provided explicit permission.

Because some farm characteristics may be inherently identifiable, the Researcher will discuss potential identification risks with the Data Provider when relevant.

5. Data Storage and Security

Research data will be stored using [institutional secure server/cloud storage/database].

The Researcher will use reasonable technical and organizational safeguards to protect the data against unauthorized access, loss, alteration, or disclosure.

Access to identifiable or confidential data will be limited to authorized members of the research team who require access for approved research activities.

Data will be retained for [X years], after which it will be securely deleted or retained in an appropriately controlled research archive when necessary for scientific or institutional purposes.

6. FAIR Data Principles

The Researcher will manage research data according to the **FAIR principles: Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable**, while respecting the Data Provider's privacy, confidentiality, ownership, and consent.

Findable

Where appropriate, research datasets will be accompanied by descriptive metadata, including information about:

- The type and origin of the data;
- Data collection methods;
- Relevant variables and definitions;
- Time period of collection;
- Data formats; and
- Applicable data-use restrictions.

Metadata may be made discoverable even when the underlying farm-level data cannot be publicly accessed.

Accessible

Data will be made accessible only to the extent permitted by this agreement and applicable privacy, confidentiality, legal, and institutional requirements.

FAIR principles do **not** require confidential farm data to be placed in a publicly accessible database.

If data are deposited in a repository, access controls may be used, including restricted or controlled access.

Interoperable

Where feasible, data will be stored using standardized formats, terminology, units, and metadata structures to facilitate responsible use with other scientific datasets.

The Researcher may standardize or harmonize data for research purposes while maintaining documentation of relevant transformations.

Reusable

Where appropriate and permitted by this agreement, research data may be reused for scientifically related purposes.

Any reuse will remain subject to applicable data-use restrictions, confidentiality requirements, and the permissions granted by the Data Provider.

The Researcher will provide sufficient documentation, including data dictionaries, methodology, and relevant metadata, to allow responsible interpretation and reuse of datasets.

7. Data Sharing and Publication

The Researcher may use the data to produce:

- Scientific publications;
- Conference presentations;
- Research reports;
- Educational materials;
- Statistical analyses; and
- Other scholarly research outputs.

Before sharing farm-level data outside the research team, the Researcher will assess whether the information could reasonably identify the Data Provider or reveal confidential farm information.

Data will not be publicly released in identifiable form without additional permission from the Data Provider.

When appropriate, aggregated or de-identified results may be shared through research publications or data repositories.

8. Secondary Research Use

The Data Provider authorizes use of the contributed data for:

- ☐ **Only the research project described in this agreement.**
- ☐ **The research project and closely related future research conducted by the Researcher or research institution.**
- ☐ **Other research purposes, provided that the data remain de-identified or subject to appropriate access controls.**

The selected option must be indicated before signing.

Any use substantially different from the purposes described above will require additional authorization when required by applicable law, institutional policy, or this agreement.

9. Withdrawal

The Data Provider may request withdrawal from the research project by contacting **[Research Contact]**.

Upon withdrawal, the Researcher will stop collecting new data from the Data Provider.

Because data may have already been incorporated into analyses, publications, or aggregated datasets, it may not always be possible to remove previously used data from completed research outputs.

The Researcher will make reasonable efforts to delete or discontinue use of identifiable data that have not yet been incorporated into completed research outputs, subject to applicable legal, regulatory, and institutional requirements.

10. Data Accuracy

The Data Provider will make reasonable efforts to provide accurate information but does not guarantee that all historical or manually recorded data are complete or error-free.

The Researcher will document relevant limitations, missing information, or data-quality issues when reporting research findings.

11. Benefits and Risks

Participation may contribute to improved scientific understanding of **[research topic]** and may support future research benefiting farmers, animals, agriculture, or related communities.

Potential risks include unintended disclosure of confidential farm information, identification of the Data Provider, or inappropriate interpretation or reuse of data.

The Researcher will take reasonable steps to minimize these risks.

12. Compensation

The Data Provider will receive **[no compensation / compensation of \$___ / other consideration]** for participation and provision of data.

Questions regarding the Data Provider's rights as a research participant may be directed to:

[Institutional Research/IRB Contact]

[Contact Information]

13. Agreement and Consent

By signing below, the Data Provider confirms that:

- They have read and understood this agreement;
- They understand the purpose of the research;
- They understand what types of farm data will be collected or provided;
- They understand how their data will be stored, analyzed, and potentially shared;
- They understand the measures that will be taken to protect confidential information;
- They understand that FAIR data practices may include creation and sharing of metadata and, where permitted, appropriately de-identified or aggregated datasets;
- They understand that FAIR principles do not automatically require confidential farm-level data to be publicly released;
- They understand their rights regarding withdrawal and data use; and
- They voluntarily agree to provide their farm data for the purposes described in this agreement.

Data Provider

Name: _____

Farm Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Principal Investigator/Researcher

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____